

Beta Cattle Tracker — User Manual

A field app for recording stocker cattle doctoring and pasture moves on an iPhone. Designed to be fast in the chute, work without cell signal, and sync to your spreadsheet automatically when reception comes back.

Quick Start (30 seconds)

1. Open the app, type your name in **Crew Member**.
2. Tap **Tag #** → keypad pops up → enter the tag → **Done**.
3. Pick **Ranch, Pasture, Lot, and Action**. Most will auto-fill once you've used the app for a day or two.
4. Confirm meds (auto-filled from your protocol — adjust dose if needed).
5. Tap **Save Record**. Done.

When you're working a chute and most fields stay the same animal-to-animal, see **Lock Buttons** below — they save you a lot of taps.

First-Time Setup

Add to home screen (do this once per phone):

- Open the app's web address in Safari (not Chrome).
- Tap the share icon at the bottom (square with arrow up).
- Tap **Add to Home Screen** → **Add**.
- Open the app from the home-screen icon from now on. It'll behave like a native app and work fully offline.

First sync. Tap  **Pull Cloud History** with cell or Wi-Fi signal. This downloads ranches, pastures, lots, medications, and protocols from your spreadsheet. Do this any time someone updates the spreadsheet.

The Three Tabs

 **Doctoring** — record treatments and dead animals. This is where you'll spend most of your time.

 **Moves** — record pasture-to-pasture moves. From → To, head count, optional notes.

 **History** — view, search, edit, or delete records from today and yesterday. Older records live in the cloud spreadsheet.

The Daily Summary Bar

The card at the top shows your running tally for today: total head treated, breakdown by 1st pull / 2nd pull / dead / other / moves, and the time and tag of your most recent save. It auto-hides when there are no records yet for the day.

Cloud Sync & Status Badge

A small badge sits next to the **Pull Cloud History** button. It tells you what's happening with your sync:

- **No badge.** Everything's synced. You're online.
-  **N pending.** N records are waiting to upload. The app retries automatically.
-  **Syncing N...** Currently uploading.
-  **Offline.** No signal. Your records are safe locally and will sync when reception comes back.
-  **Offline** • **N pending.** No signal AND records waiting.

The app retries the queue when you reconnect, when you switch back to the app, and every minute on its own. You don't need to babysit it.

If you save a record, then quickly edit and re-save it before the queue clears, only the latest version goes to the cloud. Same for save-then-delete.

Doctoring Tab — Field by Field

Crew Member

Your name. The app remembers it across sessions and shares it between Doctoring and Moves tabs.

Tag

Tap the field — a custom keypad slides up from the bottom. Enter digits, hit **Done**. The app immediately:

- Looks up prior records for that tag and shows them in the alert box (tap the alert to see details).
- Looks up which lot the tag belongs to and auto-fills it.
- If this tag has been treated before, auto-fills the ranch and pasture from the most recent record.
- Runs a safety check (won't let you record a 1st Pull on a tag that already has one, etc.).

On a desktop computer or device with a hardware keyboard, the keypad doesn't pop up — just type the tag directly. Press Enter or Escape to commit.

Buttons next to Tag #:

- **↻ (ditto, yellow)**. Repeats the most recently saved tag. Useful when correcting a save or running the same animal twice.
- **NT**. No-tag entry. Auto-numbers as NT1, NT2, NT3 and so on across your records.
- **✖ (the X inside the field)**. Clears the tag.

Date

Defaults to today. Change it only if you're entering a record after the fact.

Ranch / Pasture

Pick from the dropdowns. Pasture options update based on the selected ranch.

Lot

Auto-fills when you enter a tag that's in a known lot. You can override it manually if needed.

Action

Pick from your protocol list (1st Pull, 2nd Pull, etc.) or "Dead" or "Other". Picking an action auto-fills the medications from your saved protocol.

If you pick **Dead**, the medications section hides and a "Was it drug off?" question appears (Yes/No). This is saved with the record.

Lock Buttons (🔒 / 🔓)

Each main field — Ranch, Pasture, Lot, Action — has a small lock button next to its label. Tap to lock; the lock turns green. **A locked field stays filled in across saves.**

Ranch and Pasture are linked. Pasture can't be locked without its Ranch:

- Lock Pasture → Ranch auto-locks too.

- Unlock Ranch → Pasture auto-unlocks too.
- Lock or unlock just Ranch → Pasture is unaffected.

You can lock just Ranch (handy when working multiple pastures within one ranch) or lock both together (single-pasture chute work).

When any lock is active, a green banner appears at the top showing exactly what's locked: "🔒 Chute mode: North Ranch · West 40 · Lot 23A · 1st Pull". Quick visual check that autofill is set to the right thing.

When in chute mode, the keypad auto-opens after every save — so the next animal needs only a tag.

Recall Buttons (🔄)

Pulls the value from your most recent save. Useful for one-off recalls when you don't want to lock a field.

Medications

Three med slots. Med 1 is required when an action is selected. Meds auto-fill from the protocol associated with the chosen Action. Adjust doses as needed.

The medications section is hidden until an action calls for it. When an action is cleared (or you save without locking the action), meds hide again.

Notes

Free text. Anything that matters but doesn't fit the other fields.

Save Record

Validates, saves locally, queues for cloud upload, and shows a confirmation toast. If you tap fast multiple times, the second tap is ignored — no duplicates. The app also checks that Crew Member, Tag, Action, and Ranch are all filled before saving.

Moves Tab

Same idea but for pasture-to-pasture moves. The app prevents you from saving a move where the From and To are the same pasture. Head count is optional.

History Tab

Shows today's and yesterday's records in two tables — Doctoring on top, Moves below. Older

records live in the cloud spreadsheet.

- **Search bar.** Filters Doctoring by tag number.
- **Edit.** Loads the record back into the form for changes. Editing preserves the original treatment time so the audit trail stays accurate.
- **Del.** Tapping Del replaces it with two new buttons: a pulsing red ✓ **Delete** and a gray ✕ cancel. Nothing happens until you pick one. Auto-cancels after 5 seconds.

The  **View Today's Report** button at the bottom opens a popup with day totals.

Tag History Modal

When you enter a tag that has prior records, the alert box shows "⚠ History: N previous records — tap to view ▶". Tap the line to see every prior record for that tag in a card list:

- Action (in bold)
- Date and time
- Medications and doses
- Location and crew member
- Drug-off status (if marked dead)
- Notes

Dead records have a red border. Use this for chute decisions.

Tooltips

Hover over any button on a desktop browser to see what it does. On the iPhone, **press and hold** any button for about half a second — a dark tooltip appears with the description. Lift your finger and the button does NOT fire. Tap a button briefly (less than half a second) for normal action.

In-App Help

Two buttons at the bottom of the app:

-  **Help** — quick how-to reference.
-  **Troubleshoot** — common issues and fixes.

Both work fully offline.

Storage Self-Healing

The app stores records locally on the phone. When local storage gets close to full (after several months of use), the app automatically prunes records older than 60 days — your cloud spreadsheet keeps the long-term archive. You'll get a toast warning when this happens. If pruning isn't enough, the app will tell you to pull from cloud and clear app data.

Tips for Pasture Use

- **Add the app to your home screen** before going out. It'll work fully offline.
 - **Lock your fields** at the start of each chute session. Saves dozens of taps over a day.
 - **Don't worry about signal.** Records save locally instantly. The badge tells you when things are pending and when they've cleared.
 - **Pull cloud history** at the start of each day from the truck (when you have signal). Keeps your meds, lots, and protocols current.
 - **Glove tips:** all the small buttons (NT, ditto, lock, recall, X-in-field) are sized for gloved fingers. If something still feels small, push from the center of the icon.
 - **Confirm dialog.** Save Record asks "Save Tag X — Action?" before saving. This is a safety net.
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Privacy & Data

All your records live in two places: locally on your phone (in the browser's storage) and in the Google Sheet behind the cloud URL. Deleting the app or clearing Safari's website data wipes the local copy — pull from cloud to restore.